

Halo growth plan: reset

Written 2026-09-28, built from your real Instagram and App Store numbers plus fresh research. Everything below is meant to fit around jury service: a 15 minute daily minimum, with the bigger jobs batched into evenings and weekends, and me doing the production work.

1. Where we actually are

Instagram (last 90 days, from your Insights)

- 1,323 views from 1,000 different people. 88.6% of those people were not followers.
- 99.5% of views came from Reels. Photo posts and carousels got almost nothing (0.5%).
- Your best Reels each got 150 to 208 views: the resting breaths video (15 Jul, 208), the 8 Sep video (193), Meet Angel (191), 22 Jul (183), 9 Aug (151).
- 162 profile visits, but only 7 taps on the link in bio (4.3%).
- 72 followers, following 329.

App Store (last 30 days)

- 1 download and 1 paid purchase (\$8.16). The month before was 9 downloads, and around 4 of those were people you asked.
- Apple says App Analytics is "unavailable" for the app. It hides that data until enough people have opted in, so there is no impressions or page-view data yet.

Not checked: TikTok would not load in the browser, so I have no TikTok numbers. I did not check Facebook. Blog traffic is in Cloudflare, which needs your login (see section 10).

Outreach: one batch to cardiologists, no replies yet.

2. What the numbers actually say

1. **This is not a failed product.** A stranger paid within weeks, with almost no marketing behind it. That is the hardest signal to get and you already have it.
2. **The drop from 9 to 1 is mostly the launch bump fading.** Friends and family download first, then it goes quiet. That is normal and it is not a verdict.
3. **The funnel is tiny and leaky, not broken.** 1,323 views became 162 profile visits (12%, which is decent), then 7 link taps (4.3%, which can improve), then a handful of downloads. Nearly all of the problem is the top of the funnel: too few of the right people see anything.
4. **Reels are the only thing reaching strangers.** Under about 50K followers, Reels win reach and carousels only win once an account is established. Instagram's own ranking leans on watch time and "sends" (people DM-ing a Reel to someone). Each of your Reels tops out around 200 views because none has had a strong enough send or watch-time signal to break out yet.

5. **Zero replies from one cold email batch is normal.** Healthcare cold email gets roughly 1 to 3% replies on the first touch. A batch of a few dozen expects about 0 or 1 reply. It says nothing about the email being bad, and follow-ups are where most replies come from.
6. **Following 329 people to get 72 followers is a leak.** Liking and following broadly brings the wrong audience. It does not bring pet owners who need this.
7. **Realistic timeline.** For a focused organic strategy, getting to 100 real users usually takes 60 to 90 days, not two weeks. The aim of this sprint is to find what works and get the first strangers in, not to fix everything by the end of jury service.

3. The reset: one very specific person, one topic a week, five outputs

Who Halo is for right now: owners of cats and dogs with heart disease, and anyone told by a vet to count their pet's breathing. That is your proven winner (the resting breaths Reel), it is what Angel's story is built on, and almost nobody else serves it with a free counter. Halo does meds, weight, calendar and more, but lead with the one thing nobody else has, then let people discover the rest.

The system that fixes "it's hard to come up with new content": every week you pick ONE topic and it becomes five things.

1. **One blog post** (search traffic, lasts forever).
2. **Three Reels**, each opening with a different hook on the same topic.
3. **One carousel** (for saves, shown to followers).
4. **One helpful answer** in a community (Facebook group or Reddit), with no link at first.
5. **One line for outreach** (the topic becomes the hook for a follow-up email or a creator DM).

So you never start from a blank page. The blog is the script, and the topic repeats until it works.

4. Social plan

Switch to Reels first. Aim for 3 a week. Once a week gives Instagram too little to learn from.

The formula for every Reel

- First 2 seconds: a hook a cat or dog owner cannot scroll past. Text on screen, Angel or the counter in shot.
- 15 to 30 seconds total. One useful thing, no slow intro.
- End on a "send" prompt: "Send this to someone whose cat has a heart murmur." Sends are the strongest discovery signal.
- Put the link in bio call to action in the caption and as a pinned comment.

Six Reels to make first (I will script and caption each)

1. "Your vet said count your cat's breathing. Here's how, in 15 seconds." (a remake of your best performer with a sharper hook)

2. "This one number is the earliest warning sign of heart failure in cats." (counter demo)
3. "POV: your vet says 'keep an eye on their breathing'." (relatable, Angel asleep)
4. "24 breaths a minute or 32? Which is normal?" (comment bait, then the answer in the caption)
5. "What my cat with four heart conditions takes every day." (the pill routine, your pill footage)
6. "Three things I wish someone told me when Angel was diagnosed."

Carousels: one a week for saves, made from the same topic as the Reels. They will not bring strangers, they are for people who already follow.

Profile fixes (10 minutes, do first)

- Bio line one should say who it is for and what it does: "Free breathing rate counter + meds tracker for pets with heart disease." Right now it says "the app for pets who can't tell you", which is nice but does not tell a stranger why to tap.
- Pin your best Reel (the breathing rate one) so a new visitor sees the proof first.
- Add a "Start here" Highlight with the counter demo and a screenshot of the App Store page.
- Target: lift link taps from 4.3% of profile visits to 8%.

Engagement: stop follow-for-follow. Spend 10 minutes a day leaving genuinely useful comments on posts by owners of pets with heart disease, cat and dog vet nurses, and chronic-illness pet accounts. Those are the people who need Halo.

TikTok: post the same Reels there. I could not see your TikTok numbers, so send me a screenshot of the analytics page if you want a proper read.

5. Blog plan

You have 65 posts, all with App Store links and all in the sitemap. That part is good. The gap is that only 3 posts cover the heart and breathing topic that is your best story (heart-disease-signs-cats, resting-breathing-rate-cats, resting-breathing-rate-cats-vs-dogs). The rest spread across horses, guinea pigs, birds and general care.

Is it safe to publish 10 at once? Yes, Google does not penalise that. But it is better to stagger them (3 in week 1, then 2 to 3 a week) because each one also feeds a week of Reels. After each goes live, request indexing in Search Console (URL Inspection, Request Indexing).

The 10 to write first (each targets something an owner would actually type into Google)

1. Why is my cat breathing fast while asleep? When to worry.
2. What is a normal sleeping breathing rate for a cat with heart disease, versus a healthy cat?
3. A free printable resting breathing rate log (template plus the app).
4. Heart murmur in cats: what it means and what happens next.
5. Congestive heart failure in dogs: the signs, and how to monitor at home.
6. Hypertrophic cardiomyopathy (HCM) in cats: which breeds are higher risk and what screening involves.

7. Mitral valve disease in small dogs and Cavaliers: what to track between checks.
8. Questions to ask at a cardiology appointment (and what to bring).
9. Heart medication routines: how owners keep track of multiple doses a day.
10. A seizure diary for dogs and cats: what to log so your vet can use it. (Check the app supports this before publishing.)

Every post ends with the same call to action and the topic's Reel embedded or linked. I will write these in the same plain voice as your existing posts.

Website quick win: the site has no Smart App Banner. It is one line of code and makes iPhone visitors get an "Open / Get" banner for Halo at the top of every page. I can add it in a few minutes. Say the word.

6. Outreach plan

Fix the batch you already sent. The follow-ups are where the replies are, and you are about 13 days in.

- **Follow-up 1 (now):** reply to your own email. Do not repeat it. Add one new thing: attach a one-page sample summary (Angel's) and ask one direct, easy question: "Would a printable version be more useful than the app?"
- **Follow-up 2 (about 7 days later):** two lines, a polite last note.
- **Stop after two.** A third causes complaints, not replies.
- Expect 1 to 3 replies from the whole batch at best. Do not send the international batch until you see how the UK one lands.

Send outreach where owners are, not just specialists. A cardiologist saying yes rarely produces downloads. These are more likely to:

1. **Condition and breed communities.** Feline heart disease, kidney disease and diabetes groups, and breed clubs for breeds prone to heart disease (Cavalier King Charles Spaniels, Maine Coons, Ragdolls). Message the admins, offer the counter free, and ask permission before sharing.
2. **Small creators.** Owners of pets with heart disease on Instagram and TikTok. Offer free use and ask for honest feedback. Do not ask for a shout-out in the first message.
3. **Press and podcasts.** "Woman builds an app for her cat with four heart conditions" is a real human story. Local Surrey papers and pet podcasts are free, and it is your strongest hook. Kennel & Cattery Management is already on your list.
4. **Your own vet and cattery.** A small printed QR card at Medivet Oxted reception and Freer Farm. Warm, free, and the most trusted introduction you have.

The Medivet UK list is a reference, not a mailing list. Do not cold-email 360 practices. Use it only for a warm introduction if Oxted comes back positive.

7. Conversion fixes (all free, do these before anything else)

- Instagram bio, pinned Reel and Start here Highlight (section 4).

- Smart App Banner on the website (section 5).
- **App Store ratings.** A new app with zero ratings converts worse. Ask the people who already have the app (including the person who paid) to leave a rating. Ask kindly and once.
- **App Store name and keywords.** The listing is "Halo: Pet Medication Tracker". People who need Halo type things like "cat breathing rate" and "sleeping respiratory rate". Consider adding "Breathing Rate" to the subtitle or keywords in your next update. I could not test where Halo ranks (Apple's search tool would not respond from here), so do this check yourself: on your phone, search the App Store for "pet medication reminder", "cat breathing rate" and "cat heart disease", and tell me whether Halo shows up and where. That tells us how much ASO matters.
- **Day 3 retention.** Trackers lose people because logging is a chore. Ask the few real users: did the counter and reminders make it easy? The daily log reminder you just added is the right instinct.

8. Two weeks, built for jury service

Minimum every day (15 minutes): reply to comments, leave 3 useful comments in the target communities, answer one question in a group. That alone keeps the account alive.

Week 1

- Day 1 (tonight, 30 min): fix bio, pin Reel, Start here Highlight. Send Follow-up 1 to the cardiologists. Ask the people who have the app for a rating.
- Days 1 to 2: I write blog posts 1 to 3 and the first three Reel scripts. You approve.
- Weekend (2 to 3 hours): film all six Reels in one go with Angel. I edit, caption and give you the schedule. Publish blogs 1 to 3.
- Join or approach 3 target communities. Help first for a week, no links.

Week 2

- Post 3 Reels (Mon, Wed, Fri), each the same topic as a blog post.
- Publish blogs 4 to 7. Request indexing for each.
- Send Follow-up 2. Pitch 3 podcasts or local papers. Message 5 creators.
- Put QR cards in at Oxted and Freer Farm.
- Sunday review (below).

9. Weekly scoreboard (10 minutes, Sundays)

Write down: Reels views and non-follower share, profile visits, link taps, App Store downloads and sales (Trends), top 5 pages in Cloudflare, replies received.

Decision rules: whichever topic gets the most sends and saves, make more of it. Drop the bottom one. Do not change strategy more often than every two weeks.

Honest targets for the two weeks: 6 Reels out, at least one over 1,000 views; link taps from 4% to 8% of profile visits; 20 genuine community answers; 5 or more ratings; 10 blogs live; 5 to 10 downloads from

strangers as a stretch. If we miss, the scoreboard tells us why.

10. What I need from you

1. A screenshot of TikTok analytics and the Facebook page insights.
2. A screenshot of Cloudflare Web Analytics (top pages) so we know whether the blog is being read.
3. Confirm whether the App Store search test in section 7 shows Halo.
4. Apple has posted a notice in App Store Connect: the Apple Developer Program License Agreement has been updated and the Account Holder must accept it. Please do this soon, as it can block updates and new submissions.
5. Yes or no on: Smart App Banner, blog writing, and Reel scripts.